P

POCKETWISE

Student budgeting & expense management

Take control of your money. One decision at a time.

DESIGN CONCEPT • TAIWAN • NT$

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Individual academic design project | 2 November 2026

A calmer way to manage student money

A mobile-first budgeting concept for university students in Taiwan.

WHO

University students in Taiwan

WHY

Make everyday spending easier to understand

WHAT

Track, budget, save and review

CURRENCY

New Taiwan dollar · NT$

Project format: individual design project + clickable front-end prototype. The concept is not a live banking or payment service.

The problem is visibility, not just arithmetic

Students may manage money from several sources and spend it across frequent everyday needs.

Scattered records

Purchases may be remembered, noted or not recorded.

Small expenses add up

Frequent purchases can be hard to track consistently.

Unclear budget impact

A total alone may not show what remains in each category.

Evidence status: these are initial hypotheses based on the project brief and chosen context. Primary research is still required.

Designed around a student’s everyday decisions

Proto-persona: Mei-Ling (illustrative, not research-validated).

MEI-LING

Undergraduate student\nManages allowance and occasional income\nWants to save for a personal goal

GOALS

Know what remains • avoid overspending • save steadily

FRICTION TO VALIDATE

Forgotten purchases, cumbersome manual tracking and unclear category spending.

What success should look like

Targets are proposed and must be tested with students.

90% — Complete expense-entry task

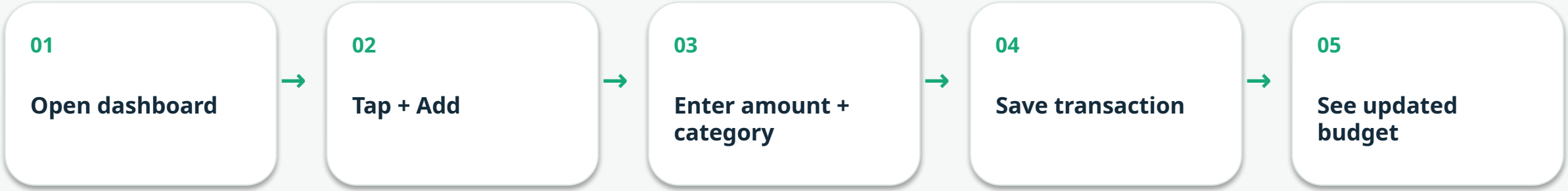
<60s — Median time to add an expense

4/5 — Identify remaining monthly budget

80% — Find transaction history without help

The key journey: record a purchase

Design around the moment a student wants to remember an expense.



Recovery: invalid amount or missing category → show a clear inline message → preserve entered details → let the user correct and retry.

Simple information architecture

Five primary mobile destinations; secondary insights and preferences remain easy to reach.

HOME

Balance, summary, recent activity

ACTIVITY

Transaction list, filters, detail

+

Add income or expense

BUDGETS

Category limits and progress

GOALS

Savings targets and contributions

Sitemap: Home → Dashboard | Activity → Transactions | Add → New entry | Budgets → Category limits | Goals → Goal detail

Prioritise the information students need

Major screens: dashboard, transaction form, budgets and savings goals.

DASHBOARD

- Available balance
- Income / expenses
- Quick add action
- Budget snapshot
- Recent activity

ADD TRANSACTION

- Expense / income toggle
- Amount in NT$
- Category + date
- Optional note
- Save + confirmation

BUDGETS

- Monthly planned total
- Spent / remaining
- Category progress
- Edit budget

GOALS

- Goal name + target
- Saved amount
- Progress indicator
- Add contribution

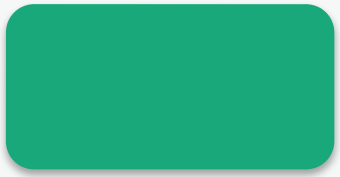
Trustworthy, calm and encouraging

A restrained visual system with strong financial-number hierarchy.



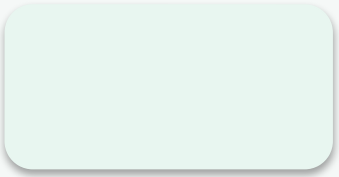
Deep navy

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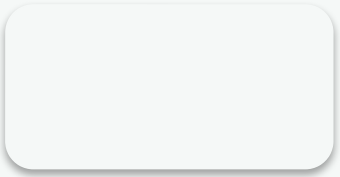
Emerald

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Soft mint

#E8F6F0



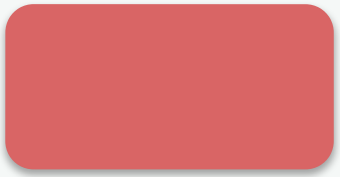
Canvas

#F5F8F7



Caution

#F2B84B



Error

#D96565

Typography: DM Sans / system sans-serif. Spacing: 8 px rhythm. Cards: 16–20 px radius. Buttons: minimum 44 px. Use labels, contrast and focus states—not colour alone.

Small enough to design well

The MVP is a useful budgeting loop, not a full financial institution.

IN THE MVP

• Dashboard\n• Manual income / expense entry\n• Transaction history\n• Category budgets\n• Savings goals\n• Basic spending insights

NOT YET

• Bank integrations\n• Payments or transfers\n• Loans / credit\n• Investment advice\n• Automated predictions\n• Production authentication

A lightweight front-end prototype

HTML, CSS and vanilla JavaScript; sample data stored locally for demonstration.

HTML

Semantic page structure

CSS

Responsive design system

JavaScript

Navigation, forms, validation and demo state

localStorage

Browser-only persistence

Future proposal: authenticated API + PostgreSQL, security and privacy review, then static prototype deployment through GitHub Pages. No real financial data should be entered.

A focused individual delivery plan

Short timeline aligned to the 3 November 2026 submission deadline.

2 NOV

Project scope + research plan

2 NOV

IA, journey, flows + wireframes

2 NOV

Visual system + prototype

3 NOV

QA, export PDFs + submit

One-person team: project direction, UX research planning, UX/UI design, prototyping, documentation and quality assurance. AI assistance is disclosed.

Transparent collaboration

AI supported ideation, document structuring, UX drafting and front-end code generation.

AI CONTRIBUTION

• Brainstorming and project framing\n• Drafting UX documentation\n• Proposing flows and layouts\n• Generating prototype code\n• Requirements checklist

HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY

• Verify content and assumptions\n• Validate with actual students\n• Test prototype interactions\n• Follow academic integrity rules\n• Approve final submission

CLOSE

Make the next money decision clearer.

PocketWise turns everyday transactions into a clearer view of spending, budgets and goals.

POCKETWISE

Take control of your money. One decision at a time.

Design concept • University students in Taiwan • New Taiwan dollar (NT$)

A working front-end prototype

The prototype extends the existing design into a testable student budgeting experience.

Implemented interactions

Dashboard totals • add income and expenses • required-field validation • transaction filtering and deletion • category budget progress • savings goals and contributions • local browser persistence.

Technology and data

HTML5 semantic structure, responsive CSS3 and vanilla JavaScript. Demo records use fictional sample data and localStorage. Amounts are represented as whole NT dollars.

Prototype boundary

This is an academic demonstration, not a bank or production financial product. Do not enter real financial records. User testing and accessibility checks still need to be performed and recorded.

Google Sheets integration pathway

A lightweight Apps Script connector is prepared; the live connection requires deployment and verification.

How it is designed to work

The front end sends the current transaction, budget and savings-goal collections to a Google Apps Script web app. The script writes the data into three Sheet tabs: Transactions, Budgets and Goals.

Setup steps

Create a Google Sheet → add the supplied Code.gs in Extensions / Apps Script → set the Sheet ID → deploy as a web app → configure the deployed URL in the prototype → run Sync to Google Sheets.

Current status and safety

Connector code is included in the source pack but is not yet live. A successful sync must be tested and captured before claiming completion. The demo endpoint is not suitable for sensitive or real financial data.

GitHub and deployment plan

The source structure supports version control and a static prototype deployment.

Repository

Create pocketwise-student-budgeting with prototype/, google-apps-script/, docs/ and README.md. Commit in small steps and keep credentials or personal data out of the repository.

Example commits

Add responsive dashboard • Implement transaction validation • Add Google Sheets connector • Add design documentation and test plan.

Deployment

Test locally, push to GitHub, enable GitHub Pages for the static prototype, then verify mobile and desktop layouts. Apps Script is deployed separately. Record repository and live URLs only after completion.

Testing and DevTools evidence

Testing results must be observed and recorded; planned tests are not presented as completed evidence.

Functional tests

Add expense and income • invalid amount and missing category • filter activity • confirm deletion • create savings goal and add contribution • reload and verify localStorage persistence.

Browser inspection

Use DevTools Console for JavaScript errors, Application / Storage for localStorage, and the device toolbar at 360 px, 390 px, tablet and desktop widths. Keyboard-test all controls and visible focus states.

Evidence to capture

Dated screenshots of the prototype, responsive layouts, console results, localStorage record, GitHub commit history and—if deployed—a successful Google Sheets sync. Record actual outcomes and issues fixed.

What the project demonstrates

The documents and prototype address the course objectives while making remaining validation tasks explicit.

Design objectives

Problem definition, target user, assumptions, goals, journey, touchpoints, information architecture, sitemap, user flow, recovery path, wireframes and visual system are documented.

Technical objectives

The prototype demonstrates HTML/CSS/JavaScript and localStorage. The Apps Script connector is prepared. GitHub publication, live Sheets sync, DevTools evidence and usability results still require execution.

Responsible AI use

AI supported ideation, UX drafting, code generation and documentation. The student reviews, adapts and remains responsible for understanding and verifying all work. Persona and research statements remain hypotheses until validated.